Your beginner strength routine

A printable companion for women starting a gym routine with a weight-loss goal. Two full-body sessions each week, with time to recover. General guidance for adults; no guaranteed weight-loss outcome.

How to use this plan

Train on two non-consecutive days, such as Monday and Thursday. Warm up with 5-10 minutes of easy movement and lighter practice sets. Start with one working set while learning; use two sets when comfortable. Finish with about 2-3 controlled repetitions in reserve. Rest around two minutes between sets, or longer as needed.

Session A	Working sets	Repetitions
Leg press	1-2	8-12
Seated cable row	1-2	8-12
Machine chest press	1-2	8-12
Glute bridge (start unweighted)	1-2	10-15
Dead bug	1-2	5-8 per side

Session B	Working sets	Repetitions
Goblet squat to bench OR leg press	1-2	8-12
Lat pulldown	1-2	8-12
Incline push-up OR machine chest press	1-2	8-12
Seated leg curl	1-2	10-15
Supported split squat*	1-2	6-8 per side

*Ask an instructor for a familiar machine alternative if balance or comfort is an issue. Use a stable support for incline push-ups. Choose one option and keep it consistent while learning.

Progress gradually

When every set reaches the top of its repetition range with good control on two visits, try the smallest available weight increase. Return towards the lower repetition target. If technique changes, reduce the load. Do not increase weight, sets and frequency together.

Stop for sharp pain or unusual symptoms. Seek individual guidance for pregnancy, postpartum recovery, injury or a condition affecting exercise. An instructor should check unfamiliar movements.

Four weeks of consistent practice

Write your chosen dates. A completed session is useful even if you adjust the workload. Rest or do comfortable activity between lifting days.

Week	Focus	Session A date	Session B date
1	Learn settings; conservative loads		
2	Repeat; use two sets if comfortable		
3	Add controlled repetitions where ready		
4	Review the log before increasing load		

Reusable session log

Date: _____ Session A / B: _____ Weight unit: kg / lb
Dumbbells recorded per hand / total: _____ Energy and recovery: _____

Exercise / chosen version	Set 1: load x reps	Set 2: load x reps

Machine settings or substitutions: _____

Next time: _____

Use Workout Studio

Save A and B as workout templates, log completed sets, repetitions and weights, and review your history before the next session. Use consistent weight conventions. The app supports organisation and logging; it does not assess technique or guarantee fat loss. Visit www.sportzlabs.com/workoutstudio/.

Research behind the principles

Hagstrom et al. (2020), Sports Medicine: strength adaptations in women. doi:10.1007/s40279-019-01247-x
ACSM (2009), Medicine & Science in Sports & Exercise: progression models. PubMed: 19204579
Binmahfoz et al. (2025), BMJ Open Sport & Exercise Medicine: resistance exercise during dietary weight loss. doi:10.1136/bmjsem-2024-002363

This exercise selection is an illustrative starter plan, not a trial-validated programme. Sustainable nutrition also matters for weight loss. Read the accompanying blog for context and evidence limitations.